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Micro-lens array optically coupled with a photonics die

Abstract

Embodiments described herein may be related to apparatuses, processes, and techniques for coupling a micro-lens array to a photonics die. In embodiments, this coupling may be performed as an attach at a wafer level. In embodiments, wafer level optical testing of the photonics die with the attached micro-lens array may be tested electrically and optically before the photonics die is assembled into a package, in various configurations. Other embodiments may be described and/or claimed.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to the field of semiconductor packaging, and in particular to micro-lens arrays physically and optically coupled with a photonics die.

BACKGROUND

(2) Continued growth in virtual machines and cloud computing will continue to increase the demand for high-quality optical receiver and transmitter devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates a side view and a bottom view of an example legacy photonics package with optical fibers optically coupled to a photonics die using one or more V-grooves.

(2) FIG. 2 illustrates a front view of a photonics die that includes a micro-lens array, in accordance

with various embodiments.

(3) FIG. 3 illustrates a front and a top view of a photonics die that includes multiple micro-lens arrays, in accordance with various embodiments.

(4) FIG. 4 illustrates an example of physical alignment features to align a micro-lens array onto a photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments.

(5) FIG. 5 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die coupled with a substrate that has an opening to allow a light path to reach a micro-lens array on the photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments.

(6) FIG. 6 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die coupled with a substrate and overhanging the substrate, with a deflection prism coupled with the substrate to change direction of light along a light path to a micro-lens array coupled with the photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments.

(7) FIG. 7 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die coupled with the substrate having an opening to allow a light path to reach a micro-lens array on the photonics die, where the light path includes a lens coupled with the substrate, in accordance with various embodiments.

(8) FIG. 8 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die with a micro-lens array coupled to a side of the photonics die facing an integrated heat spreader (IHS) that has a micro-lens array directed toward the photonics die to optically coupled with the photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments.

(9) FIG. 9 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die with a micro-lens array coupled to a side of the photonics die facing an IHS having an opening to provide a light path for the micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments.

(10) FIG. 10 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die with a micro-lens array coupled to a side of the photonics die facing an IHS with a deflection prism coupled with the IHS to change direction of light along a path to the micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments.

(11) FIG. 11 illustrates an example process for manufacturing a photonics die with a micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments.

(12) FIG. 12 schematically illustrates a computing device, in accordance with embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(13) Embodiments described herein may be related to apparatuses, processes, and techniques related to coupling a micro-lens array to a photonics die. In embodiments, this coupling may be performed as an attach at a wafer level. In embodiments, wafer level optical testing of the photonics die with an attached micro-lens array may be tested electrically and optically before the photonics die is assembled into a package, resulting in a higher package yield.

(14) For photonics packaging, including silicon photonics packaging, one challenge is to have highly accurate alignments between silicon optical waveguides and external optical waveguides. For example, between optical fibers that are coupled with optical waveguides of an optical transceiver. Typically, accurate alignments require a nanometer (nm) level alignment accuracy. In addition, the interface should be robust to endure operational stresses without degradation in reliability and/or optical performance degradation.

(15) In embodiments, the micro-lens array may use collimated optical beams. This may reduce, afterward-alignment accuracy requirements, which in turn may facilitate low-cost/high-volume manufacturing (HVM)-scalable packaging processes that include these photonics dies. For example, without using a lens array, the alignment accuracy needed for a quality optical coupling may be ~1-2 μm . With a lens array, this alignment accuracy may be relaxed to ~10 μm or so. This is because a lens can collimate the beam of light to a larger diameter. Thus, a lower alignment requirement can be achieved using less expensive tooling and faster manufacturing processes. In addition, process control requirements may be less stringent. Thus, in embodiments higher yields can be obtained using lenses.

(16) In the following detailed description, reference is made to the accompanying drawings which form a part hereof, wherein like numerals designate like parts throughout, and in which is shown by way of illustration embodiments in which the subject matter of the present disclosure may be practiced. It is to be understood that other embodiments may be utilized and structural or logical changes may be made without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. Therefore, the following detailed description is not to be taken in a limiting sense, and the scope of embodiments is defined by the appended claims and their equivalents.

(17) For the purposes of the present disclosure, the phrase “A and/or B” means (A), (B), or (A and B). For the purposes of the present disclosure, the phrase “A, B, and/or C” means (A), (B), (C), (A and B), (A and C), (B and C), or (A, B and C).

(18) The description may use perspective-based descriptions such as top/bottom, in/out, over/under, and the like. Such descriptions are merely used to facilitate the discussion and are not intended to restrict the application of embodiments described herein to any particular orientation.

(19) The description may use the phrases “in an embodiment,” or “in embodiments,” which may each refer to one or more of the same or different embodiments. Furthermore, the terms “comprising,” “including,” “having,” and the like, as used with respect to embodiments of the present disclosure, are synonymous.

(20) The term “coupled with,” along with its derivatives, may be used herein. “Coupled” may mean one or more of the following. “Coupled” may mean that two or more elements are in direct physical or electrical contact. However, “coupled” may also mean that two or more elements indirectly contact each other, but yet still cooperate or interact with each other, and may mean that one or more other elements are coupled or connected between the elements that are said to be coupled with each other. The term “directly coupled” may mean that two or more elements are in direct contact.

(21) Various operations may be described as multiple discrete operations in turn, in a manner that is most helpful in understanding the claimed subject matter. However, the order of description should not be construed as to imply that these operations are necessarily order dependent.

(22) As used herein, the term “module” may refer to, be part of, or include an ASIC, an electronic circuit, a processor (shared, dedicated, or group) and/or memory (shared, dedicated, or group) that execute one or more software or firmware programs, a combinational logic circuit, and/or other suitable components that provide the described functionality.

(23) Various Figures herein may depict one or more layers of one or more package assemblies. The layers depicted herein are depicted as examples of relative positions of the layers of the different package assemblies. The layers are depicted for the purposes of explanation, and are not drawn to scale. Therefore, comparative sizes of layers should not be assumed from the Figures, and sizes, thicknesses, or dimensions may be assumed for some embodiments only where specifically indicated or discussed.

(24) FIG. 1 illustrates a side view and a bottom view of an example legacy photonics package with optical fibers optically coupled to a photonics die using one or more V-grooves. Legacy package **100** shows a partial side view of a legacy photonics package that includes a photonics die **102** that is electrically coupled with an XPU **104**. In embodiments, the photonics die **102** and the XPU **104** may be electrically coupled using an electrical interface **105**. The electrical interface **105** may include an interconnect bridge, such as an embedded multi-die interconnect bridge (EMIB), or a silicon interposer, organic routing on substrate **106** or a redistribution layer (RDL) on substrate **106**, or some other electrical coupling. In embodiments, the electrical coupling may be a high density electrical coupling.

(25) In implementations, the XPU **104** and the photonics die **102** may be thermally coupled to an integrated heat spreader (IHS) **108**. In implementations, there may be a thermal interface material (TIM) (not shown), such as a thermal paste, that is disposed between the IHS **108** and the XPU **104** and photonics die **102** to route heat away from the XPU **104** and photonics die **102**.

(26) In implementations, the photonics die **102** may overhang the substrate **106** where V-grooves **110** may be used to align a first set of optical fibers **112** so that they are optically coupled with the photonics die **102**. In other implementations, these V-grooves **110** may take various other shapes and dimensions as required to facilitate a high quality optical coupling with the photonics die **102**. In implementations, an epoxy **113** may be applied to secure the first set of optical fibers **112** to the photonics die **102**.

(27) A support structure **114** may be physically coupled with the IHS **108** to support the first set of optical fibers **112** to facilitate the quality and robustness of the optical connection of the first set of optical fibers **112** with the photonics die **102**. In other embodiments, the support structure **114** may be physically coupled with some other component of the legacy package **100**. In implementations, the fibers **112** may optically couple with an optical coupler **116**, which may be implemented as a ferrule or other similarly functioning device, to optically couple with light sources outside legacy package **100**. In embodiments, the optical coupler **116** may be seen as a “pigtail” to which one or more optical fibers (not shown) may be inserted during assembly of the legacy package **100** into a computing system to create an optical circuit that includes the first set of optical fibers **112** and the photonics die **102**.

(28) In implementations, the substrate **106** may be coupled with a printed circuit board (PCB) **117** using solder ball connections **118** in a ball attach process. In other implementations, the substrate **106** may be coupled with the PCB **117** using bumps, land pads, pins, or some other electrical and/or physical coupling mechanism.

(29) In implementations of legacy package **100**, each fiber of the first set of optical fibers **112** needs to align with the silicon waveguide in the photonics die **102** very accurately. With a long pigtail, where the first set of optical fibers **112** may include 24 individual fibers per photonics die. In other implementations of legacy package **100**, there may be multiple photonics dies (not shown), for example, up to six photonics dies per package, each with a single fiber **112** sitting in a V-groove **110** and bonded by optical epoxy **113**. This legacy assembly may lack physical, optical, and/or electrical robustness during handling and operation.

(30) FIG. 2 illustrates a front view of a photonics die that includes a micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments. Diagram **200** shows a photonics die **202**, which may be similar to photonics die **102** of FIG. 1, that includes a micro-lens array **220** that is optically coupled with the photonics die **202**. In embodiments, a micro-lens array **220** may have one lens per fiber. So, if a fiber pitch is 125-250 um pitch, the micro-lens array **220** will have the same pitch. Thus, the micro-lens array **220** may be a very small array, and may be typically manufactured in array form. Since the micro-lens array **220** is at micro scale, it is referred to as a micro-lens array **220**.

(31) In embodiments, the micro-lens array **220** may be optically coupled using an epoxy **224**, which may be similar to epoxy **113** of FIG. 1. In embodiments, the epoxy **224** may be an optical adhesive used to bond or cement optical components together. Optical adhesives may allow for precise positioning of optical components prior to physically attaching to the photonics die **202**, and do not obscure a light path once the adhesive is cured.

(32) In embodiments, the photonics die **202** may include a bump region **240**, which includes multiple bumps **242** that may be used to electrically couple with an electrical interface such as electrical interface **105** of FIG. 1. In embodiments, the bump region **240** may be referred to as a first level interconnect (FLI) bump region. In embodiments, the electrical interface to which the bump region **240** may be electrically coupled may be an EMIB to facilitate high-speed electrical communication between the photonics die **202** and another package die, for example XPU **104** of FIG. 1. In embodiments, there may be an epoxy barrier **244** that may be physically applied to the photonics die **202** and positioned between the micro-lens array **220** and the bump region **240**. The epoxy barrier **244** has a height that will prevent epoxy **224** from entering the bump region **240** during the manufacturing process. The epoxy barrier **244** will prevent the epoxy **224** from interfering with the electrical operation and/or subsequent attach of the bump region **240** to another

component, such as the electrical interface **105** or the substrate **106** of FIG. **1**, during the manufacturing process when the micro-lens array **220** is coupled with the photonics die **202**.

(33) Turning now to the detail of the micro-lens array and where it attaches to the photonics die, the micro-lens array **220** may be positioned proximate to a grating coupler **246**. In embodiments, the grating coupler **246** may be used for vertically optically coupling light, and may include periodic etch structures designed to diffract light in a different direction. In embodiments, a light path **248** may transmit light within the photonics die **202**, and may be optically coupled with the grating coupler **246**. The grating coupler **246** may then change the direction of the optical path **250** toward a lens **222** of the micro-lens array **220**. By varying the position of the grating coupler **246** within the photonics die **202** in relation to the lens **222**, or by varying the design of the grating coupler **246**, the direction light path **250** may be designed for a particular angle. In embodiments, there may be a grating coupler **246** associated with each of the lenses **222** of the micro-lens array **220**.

(34) FIG. **3** illustrates a front and a top view of a photonics die that includes multiple micro-lens arrays, in accordance with various embodiments. Micro-lens arrays **320**, **321**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **220** of FIG. **2**, are arranged on a photonic die **302**, which may be similar to photonic die **202** of FIG. **2**. As shown, the micro-lens arrays **320**, **321** are oriented in a line, and are physically and optically coupled with the photonic die **302** using an epoxy **324**, which may be similar to epoxy **224** of FIG. **2**. In embodiments, epoxy barrier **344**, which may be similar to epoxy barrier **244** of FIG. **2**, is physically coupled with the photonics die **302**. The epoxy barrier **344** may serve to protect, for example a first level interconnect bump region **340**, that may be used to electrically couple the photonics die to an interconnect bridge or to another die.

(35) As shown, each of the lenses **322** and lenses **323**, which may be similar to lens **222** of FIG. **2**, are oriented in a line and may be grouped within a particular micro-lens array **320**, **321**. FIG. **3** shows just one example of a micro-lens array layout. In other embodiments, the micro-lens arrays **320**, **321** may be parallel with each other (not shown). A different number of individual lenses **322**, **323** may be used with various micro-lens arrays **320**, **321**.

(36) FIG. **4** illustrates an example of physical alignment features to align a micro-lens array onto a photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments. As discussed above and elsewhere herein, accurate alignment between waveguides within a photonics die and external waveguides, at a nanometer level, is very important for optical performance and optical signal quality. In embodiments, micro-lens array **420**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **320** of FIG. **3** may be positioned onto a photonics die **402**, which may be similar to photonics die **302** of FIG. **3**, with great precision using physical alignment features.

(37) In one embodiment, as shown, a V-groove **428** may be created in a surface of the photonics die **402** at a required depth to mate with a bump **403** that is placed on a side of the micro-lens array **420** opposite the side that includes the lenses **422**. In embodiments, the V-groove **428** and the bump **403** may be dimensioned so that there is almost no positioning variation when the micro-lens array **420** is applied to the photonics die **402**. The V-groove **428** may be created using the same anisotropic etching technique as the other V-grooves for fibers. V-groove **428** may be long as a groove or it can also be an inverted pyramid. Before etching the V-grooves **428** (or V pyramids), a mask layer (not shown) is deposited on the silicon (typically silicon nitride or oxide). The mask layer openings (not shown) are created using lithography. All V-groove **428** openings can be created in a single lithography step which eliminates any XY alignment errors between V-groove **428** and other V grooves. As the micro-lens array **420** is self-aligned in **428** and fibers, which may be similar to fibers **112** of FIG. **1**, are self-aligned in the fiber V-grooves, which may be similar to V-grooves **110** of FIG. **1**, the position error between lens array and fibers becomes very small. In other embodiments, a groove (not shown) may be made into a side of the micro-lens array **420**, and a bump (not shown) may be created on the surface of the photonics die **402**. In embodiments, an epoxy **424**, which may be similar to epoxy **324** of FIG. **3**, may be applied before the micro-lens array **420** is applied to the photonics die **402**.

(38) In embodiments, there may be multiple V-grooves **428** and/or bumps **403** applied in different orientations along a side of the micro-lens array **420** (not shown), in order to provide alignment in both an X and a Y direction along the surface of the photonics die **402**. In embodiments, these physical alignment features may be important to align the various lenses **422** with various grating couplers, such as grating coupler **246** of FIG. 2 to facilitate optimal optical path alignment.

(39) The descriptions above with respect to FIGS. 2-4 are generally directed to physically and optically coupling a micro-lens array, such as micro-lens array **420**, to a photonics die such as photonics die **402**. The discussion below is generally directed to optically coupling optical paths outside the photonics die **402** with the photonics die **402** using the micro-lens array **420**.

(40) FIG. 5 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die coupled with a substrate that has an opening to allow a light path to reach a micro-lens array on the photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments. Photonics package **500** shows a photonics die **502**, that may be similar to photonics die **302** of FIG. 3, that is electrically coupled with XPU **504**, thermally coupled with IHS **508**, and physically and/or electrically coupled with substrate **506**, which may be similar to XPU **104**, IHS **108**, and substrate **106** of FIG. 1. A micro-lens array **520**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **320** of FIG. 3, is optically coupled with the photonics die **502**. In embodiments the photonics die **502** may be an optical receiver, optical transmitter, and/or optical transceiver.

(41) Substrate **506** includes a cavity **530** into which all or part of the micro-lens array **520** may be inserted. The cavity **530** may serve as a light path between a lens **522** of the micro-lens array **520** of the photonics die **502** and a lens **542** of a second micro-lens array **540** that may be coupled with a side **517** of the substrate **506** opposite the photonics die **502**. In embodiments, the cavity **530** may include a waveguide, a light-transmitting material, or one or more optical fibers. In embodiments, the light-transmitting material may include optical adhesive, silicon, or glass. In embodiments, the cavity **530** may be an open air channel. In embodiments, the cavity **530** may be made into the substrate **506** during the time of substrate manufacture.

(42) In embodiments, the second micro-lens array **540** may be coupled with the side **517** of the substrate **506** using an epoxy **524**, which may be similar to epoxy **224** of FIG. 2, or can be mechanically plugged in from the BGA side of the substrate **517**. A waveguide **541**, which may be a light-transmitting material or one or more optical fibers, may optically couple with the second micro-lens array **540**. In embodiments, there may be multiple micro-lens arrays **520** coupled with the photonics die **502**, which will be aligned with multiple second micro-lens arrays **540** and optically coupled through cavity **530**. In embodiments, light may be transmitted and/or received from a ball grid array (BGA) side **517** of the substrate **506**.

(43) FIG. 6 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die coupled with a substrate and overhanging the substrate, with a deflection prism coupled with the substrate to change direction of light along a light path to a micro-lens array coupled with the photonics die, in accordance with various embodiments. Photonics package **600** shows a photonics die **602** that is electrically coupled with XPU **604**, thermally coupled with IHS **608**, and physically and/or electrically coupled with substrate **606**, which may be similar to photonics die **502**, XPU **504**, IHS **508**, and substrate **506** of FIG. 5. A micro-lens array **620**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **520** of FIG. 5, is optically coupled with the photonics die **602**. As shown, the portion of the photonics die **602** that includes the micro-lens array **620** may be disposed in an overhang portion **603** above the substrate **606**.

(44) As shown with this embodiment, the overhang portion **603** may also include a deflection mechanism **646** to change direction of the light path entering or leaving the micro-lens array **620**. In embodiments, this mechanism **646** may be a deflection prism, a 45° reflector, which can be created through certain surface coating, or through refractive index difference. The deflection mechanism **646** may provide optical coupling for light entering or leaving the micro-lens array **620**. In embodiments this light may travel down fiber array **648**. In embodiments, each fiber of the fiber

array **648** may include a lensed facet **649** to transmit and receive light to and from the deflection mechanism **646**, or this can be a lens array attached to the fiber array end.

(45) In embodiments, fiber array **648** may be physically coupled with the substrate **606**. In embodiments, the fiber array may be secured by a connector body **650**, which may be physically coupled with the substrate **606**. The connector body **650** top plate may secure the fiber array **648** defined in certain pitch.

(46) An alignment hole **652** is included in the ferrule design. In this way, a mating ferrule of another fiber connector with an array of optical fibers (not shown) may be inserted into the alignment hole **652** and provide a high-quality optical coupling with the fiber array **648**. In embodiments, magnets **654** may be positioned proximate to the alignment hole **652** to provide for holding the external fiber connector ferrule (not shown) into the alignment hole **652**. The magnets **654** may provide a way for the plurality of optical fibers (not shown) to become unplugged if undue force is applied to the plurality of optical fibers, so that they are unplugged rather than broken by the undue force.

(47) FIG. 7 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die coupled with the substrate having an opening to allow a light path to reach a micro-lens array on the photonics die, where the light path includes a lens coupled with the substrate, in accordance with various embodiments. Photonics package **700** shows a photonics die **702** that is electrically coupled with XPU **704**, thermally coupled with IHS **708**, and physically and/or electrically coupled with substrate **706**, which may be similar to photonics die **502**, XPU **504**, IHS **508**, and substrate **506** of FIG. 5. A micro-lens array **720**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **520** of FIG. 5, is optically coupled with the photonics die **702**. As shown, the portion of the photonics die **702** that includes the micro-lens array **720** may be disposed on the substrate **706** and above a cavity **703** in the substrate **706**.

(48) In embodiments, a connector body **750**, which may be similar to connector body **650** of FIG. 6, may partially or completely fill the cavity **703** in the substrate **706**. In embodiments, the connector body **750** may be a metal, an insulator, a dielectric, or some other material that may be used to support waveguide **748**, which may be similar to waveguide **648** of FIG. 6. A second micro-lens array **730** may be physically coupled with and/or embedded into the connector body **750**. In embodiments, the second micro-lens array **730** may be aligned with the micro-lens array **720** provide a high-quality optical connection between the two arrays. Second micro-lens array **730** may be optically coupled with a waveguide **731** that will conduct light to waveguide **748**.

(49) In embodiments, waveguide **748** may be a silicon waveguide, and optical fiber waveguide, or an open-air cavity through which light signals may be transmitted. In embodiments, one end of the waveguide **749** may angled so that the optical path **731** may be turned so that light signals may flow down through waveguide **748**. In embodiments, the second micro-lens array **730** may be directly physically and optically coupled with the waveguide **748**. In embodiments, the waveguide **748** may be a fiber array, an open-air channel, or some other medium able to conduct light. For the non-fiber cases, the channel surface of this waveguide needs to be smooth enough to avoid non-necessary light scattering, and the surrounding materials should also be properly selected in the right range of refractive index to avoid light leaking out.

(50) In embodiments, the other end of the waveguide **748** may optically couple with an alignment hole **752**, which may be similar to alignment hole **652** of FIG. 6. In this way, a plurality of optical fibers (not shown) may be inserted into the alignment hole **752** and provide a high-quality optical coupling with the waveguide **748**. In embodiments, magnets **754**, which may be similar to magnets **654** of FIG. 6, may be positioned proximate to the alignment hole **752** to provide for holding the plurality of optical fibers (not shown) into the alignment hole **752**. The magnets **754** may provide a way for the plurality of optical fibers (not shown) to become unplugged if undue force is applied to the plurality of optical fibers, such that they are unplugged rather than broken by the undue force.

(51) FIG. 8 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die with a micro-lens array coupled to a side of the photonics die facing an integrated heat spreader (IHS) that has a micro-lens array directed toward the photonics die to optically coupled with the photonics die, in accordance

with various embodiments. Photonics package **800** shows a photonics die **802** that is electrically coupled with XPU **804**, thermally coupled with IHS **808**, and physically and/or electrically coupled with substrate **806**, which may be similar to photonics die **502**, XPU **504**, IHS **508**, and substrate **506** of FIG. 5. Photonics package **800** shows an example embodiment using an open cavity Photonic Integrated Chip (OCPIC) to directly electrically couple the photonics die **802** with the XPU **804**.

(52) A micro-lens array **820**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **520** of FIG. 5, is optically coupled with the photonics die **802**. As shown, the photonics die **802** that includes the micro-lens array **820** may be disposed on the substrate **806** and at least a portion of the photonics die **802** will be within a cavity **803** above the substrate **806**. Note that the photonics die **802** may have bumps (not shown), similar to bumps **242** of FIG. 2, on both sides of the photonic die **802** in order to electrically couple with both the XPU **804** and the substrate **806**.

(53) In embodiments, a second micro-lens array **830** may be coupled with a portion of the IHS **808**. In embodiments, the second micro-lens array **830** may be coupled proximate to or at an edge of the IHS **808** that is proximate to the cavity **803**. In embodiments, an optical path **848** may extend from the micro-lens array **830** through the integrated heat spreader **808**. In embodiments, the optical path **848** may be a fiber-optic array, or some other waveguide. In embodiments, the substrate **806** may be electrically and/or physically coupled with a PCB **816** using a BGA **818**.

(54) In embodiments, the photonics die **802** may include a grating coupler (not shown) such as grating coupler **246** of FIG. 2. The grating coupler is to change the direction of the light path from, for example, perpendicular to the photonics die, to a waveguide that may be similar to waveguide **248** of FIG. 2, that is parallel to and included within the photonics die **802**. This waveguide may be optically coupled with the micro-lens array **820**.

(55) FIG. 9 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die with a micro-lens array coupled to a side of the photonics die facing an IHS having an opening to provide a light path for the micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments. Photonics package **900** shows a photonics die **902** that is electrically coupled with XPU **904**, thermally coupled with IHS **908**, and physically and/or electrically coupled with substrate **906**, which may be similar to photonics die **502**, XPU **504**, IHS **508**, and substrate **506** of FIG. 5. Photonics package **900** shows an example embodiment using an OCB to directly electrically couple the photonics die **902** with the XPU **904**.

(56) A micro-lens-array **920**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **520** of FIG. 5, is optically coupled with the photonics die **902**. As shown, the photonics die **902** that includes the micro-lens-array **920** may be disposed on the substrate **906** and at least a portion of the photonics die **902** will be within a cavity **903** above the substrate **906**. Note that the photonics die **902** may have bumps (not shown), similar to bumps **242** of FIG. 2, on both sides of the photonic die **902** in order to electrically couple with both the XPU **904** and the substrate **906**.

(57) In embodiments, a second micro-lens array **930** may be coupled with a portion of the IHS **908**. In embodiments, the second micro-lens array **930** may be coupled at or proximate to an outside edge of the IHS **908**. In these embodiments, a cavity **901**, that may be coupled with cavity **903**, may be formed through the IHS **908** to allow light signals to pass from second micro-lens array **930** to micro-lens array **920**. In embodiments, an optical path **948** may extend from the micro-lens array **930** to the outside of the optical package **900**. In embodiments, the optical path **948** may be a fiber-optic array, or some other waveguide. In embodiments, the substrate **906** may be electrically and/or physically coupled with a PCB **916** using a BGA **918**.

(58) In embodiments, the photonics die **902** may include a grating coupler (not shown) such as grating coupler **246** of FIG. 2. The grating coupler is to change the direction of the light path from, for example, perpendicular to the photonics die **902**, to a waveguide (not shown), but may be similar to waveguide **248** of FIG. 2, that is parallel to and included within the photonics die **902**. This waveguide may be optically coupled with the micro-lens array **920**.

(59) FIG. 10 illustrates an example package that includes a photonics die with a micro-lens array

coupled to a side of the photonics die facing an IHS with a deflection prism coupled with the IHS to change direction of light along a path to the micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments. Photonics package **1000** shows a photonics die **1002** that is electrically coupled with XPU **1004**, thermally coupled with IHS **1008**, and physically and/or electrically coupled with substrate **1006**, which may be similar to photonics die **502**, XPU **504**, IHS **508**, and substrate **506** of FIG. 5. Photonics package **1000** shows an example embodiment using an OCB to directly electrically couple the photonics die **1002** with the XPU **1004**.

(60) A micro-lens-array **1020**, which may be similar to micro-lens array **520** of FIG. 5, is optically coupled with the photonics die **1002**. As shown, the photonics die **1002** that includes the micro-lens-array **1020** may be disposed on the substrate **1006**, and at least a portion of the photonics die **1002** will be within a cavity **1003** above the substrate **1006**. Note that the photonics die **1002** may have bumps (not shown), similar to bumps **242** of FIG. 2, on both sides of the photonic die **1002** in order to electrically and/or physically couple with both the XPU **1004** and the substrate **1006**.

(61) In embodiments, a deflection mechanism **1046** may be physically coupled with the IHS **1008**. In embodiments, the deflection mechanism **1046** may be at an angle to cause light in a light path from micro-lens array **1020** to change direction and to flow into an optical path **1048**. In embodiments, optical path **1048** may be a waveguide or an optical fiber or an optical fiber array, with the fibers having a lensed facet **1049**. In embodiments, the lensed facet **1049** may serve to increase the quality of the optical coupling between the micro-lens array **1020** and the optical path **1048**. In embodiments, an end of the optical path **1048** may include one or more mechanisms as described above with respect to FIG. 6, including alignment holes **652** and magnets **654**.

(62) In embodiments, the photonics die **1002** may include a grating coupler (not shown) such as grating coupler **246** of FIG. 2. The grating coupler is to change the direction of the light path from, for example, perpendicular to the photonics die **1002**, to a waveguide (not shown), but may be similar to waveguide **248** of FIG. 2, that is parallel to and included within the photonics die **1002**. This waveguide is optically coupled with the micro-lens array **1020**.

(63) FIG. 11 illustrates an example process for manufacturing a photonics die with a micro-lens array, in accordance with various embodiments. Process **1100** may be performed using apparatus, systems, techniques, or processes as described herein, and particularly with respect to FIGS. 1-10. The process may start at block **1102**.

(64) At block **1102**, the process may include identifying a photonics die. In embodiments, the photonics die may be similar to photonics die **202** of FIG. 2, **302** of FIG. 3, **402** of FIG. 4, **502** of FIG. 5, **602** of FIG. 6, **702** of FIG. 7, **802** of FIG. 8, **902** of FIG. 9, and/or **1002** of FIG. 10. In embodiments, the photonics die may include a photonics integrated circuit. In embodiments, the photonics die may be electrically and/or physically coupled with a substrate such as substrate **206** of FIG. 2. In embodiments, the photonics die may be electrically and/or physically coupled with an XPU such as XPU **204** of FIG. 2. In embodiments, the photonics die may be directly physically coupled with an XPU such as XPU **1004** of FIG. 10. In embodiments, the photonics die may include a grating coupler, such as grating coupler **246** of FIG. 2, that may be used to change the direction of an optical path within the photonics die.

(65) At block **1104**, the process may further include identifying a micro-lens array, the micro-lens array includes one or more lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple channels. In embodiments, the micro-lens array may be similar to micro-lens array **220** of FIG. 2, **320**, **321** of FIG. 3, **420** of FIG. 4, **520** of FIG. 5, **620** of FIG. 6, **720** of FIG. 7, **820** of FIG. 8, **920** of FIG. 9, and/or **1020** of FIG. 10. In embodiments, the micro-lens array may include multiple lenses, such as lens **222** of FIG. 2.

(66) At block **1106**, the process may further include optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die. In embodiments, this coupling may be accomplished using an optical epoxy, such as optical epoxy **224** of FIG. 2. In other embodiments, the alignment of the micro-lens array and the photonics die coupling may be facilitated by one or more physical

features, such as V-groove **428** within photonics die **402** and bump **403** that may be part of the micro-lens array **420** of FIG. 4.

(67) FIG. 11 schematically illustrates a computing device, in accordance with embodiments. The computer system **1100** (also referred to as the electronic system **1100**) as depicted can embody all or part of one or more micro-lens array optically coupled with a photonics die, according to any of the several disclosed embodiments and their equivalents as set forth in this disclosure. The computer system **1100** may be a mobile device such as a netbook computer. The computer system **1100** may be a mobile device such as a wireless smart phone. The computer system **1100** may be a desktop computer. The computer system **1100** may be a hand-held reader. The computer system **1100** may be a server system. The computer system **1100** may be a supercomputer or high-performance computing system.

(68) In an embodiment, the electronic system **1100** is a computer system that includes a system bus **1120** to electrically couple the various components of the electronic system **1100**. The system bus **1120** is a single bus or any combination of busses according to various embodiments. The electronic system **1100** includes a voltage source **1130** that provides power to the integrated circuit **1110**. In some embodiments, the voltage source **1130** supplies current to the integrated circuit **1110** through the system bus **1120**.

(69) The integrated circuit **1110** is electrically coupled to the system bus **1120** and includes any circuit, or combination of circuits according to an embodiment. In an embodiment, the integrated circuit **1110** includes a processor **1112** that can be of any type. As used herein, the processor **1112** may mean any type of circuit such as, but not limited to, a microprocessor, a microcontroller, a graphics processor, a digital signal processor, or another processor. In an embodiment, the processor **1112** includes, or is coupled with, all or part of one or more micro-lens array optically coupled with a photonics die, as disclosed herein. In an embodiment, SRAM embodiments are found in memory caches of the processor. Other types of circuits that can be included in the integrated circuit **1110** are a custom circuit or an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), such as a communications circuit **1114** for use in wireless devices such as cellular telephones, smart phones, pagers, portable computers, two-way radios, and similar electronic systems, or a communications circuit for servers. In an embodiment, the integrated circuit **1110** includes on-die memory **1116** such as static random-access memory (SRAM). In an embodiment, the integrated circuit **1110** includes embedded on-die memory **1116** such as embedded dynamic random-access memory (eDRAM).

(70) In an embodiment, the integrated circuit **1110** is complemented with a subsequent integrated circuit **1111**. Useful embodiments include a dual processor **1113** and a dual communications circuit **1115** and dual on-die memory **1117** such as SRAM. In an embodiment, the dual integrated circuit **1110** includes embedded on-die memory **1117** such as eDRAM.

(71) In an embodiment, the electronic system **1100** also includes an external memory **1140** that in turn may include one or more memory elements suitable to the particular application, such as a main memory **1142** in the form of RAM, one or more hard drives **1144**, and/or one or more drives that handle removable media **1146**, such as diskettes, compact disks (CDs), digital variable disks (DVDs), flash memory drives, and other removable media known in the art. The external memory **1140** may also be embedded memory **1148** such as the first die in a die stack, according to an embodiment.

(72) In an embodiment, the electronic system **1100** also includes a display device **1150**, an audio output **1160**. In an embodiment, the electronic system **1100** includes an input device such as a controller **1170** that may be a keyboard, mouse, trackball, game controller, microphone, voice-recognition device, or any other input device that inputs information into the electronic system **1100**. In an embodiment, an input device **1170** is a camera. In an embodiment, an input device **1170** is a digital sound recorder. In an embodiment, an input device **1170** is a camera and a digital sound recorder.

(73) As shown herein, the integrated circuit **1110** can be implemented in a number of different embodiments, including one or more micro-lens array optically coupled with a photonics die, according to any of the several disclosed embodiments and their equivalents, an electronic system, a computer system, one or more methods of fabricating an integrated circuit, and one or more methods of fabricating an electronic assembly that includes a package substrate implementing all or part of one or more micro-lens array optically coupled with a photonics die, according to any of the several disclosed embodiments as set forth herein in the various embodiments and their art-recognized equivalents. The elements, materials, geometries, dimensions, and sequence of operations can all be varied to suit particular I/O coupling requirements including array contact count, array contact configuration for a microelectronic die embedded in a processor mounting substrate according to any of the several disclosed processes used for one or more micro-lens array optically coupled with a photonics die and their equivalents. A foundation substrate may be included, as represented by the dashed line of FIG. **11**. Passive devices may also be included, as is also depicted in FIG. **11**.

(74) Various embodiments may include any suitable combination of the above-described embodiments including alternative (or) embodiments of embodiments that are described in conjunctive form (and) above (e.g., the “and” may be “and/or”). Furthermore, some embodiments may include one or more articles of manufacture (e.g., non-transitory computer-readable media) having instructions, stored thereon, that when executed result in actions of any of the above-described embodiments. Moreover, some embodiments may include apparatuses or systems having any suitable means for carrying out the various operations of the above-described embodiments.

(75) The above description of illustrated embodiments, including what is described in the Abstract, is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit embodiments to the precise forms disclosed. While specific embodiments are described herein for illustrative purposes, various equivalent modifications are possible within the scope of the embodiments, as those skilled in the relevant art will recognize.

(76) These modifications may be made to the embodiments in light of the above detailed description. The terms used in the following claims should not be construed to limit the embodiments to the specific implementations disclosed in the specification and the claims. Rather, the scope of the invention is to be determined entirely by the following claims, which are to be construed in accordance with established doctrines of claim interpretation.

(77) The following paragraphs describe examples of various embodiments.

EXAMPLES

(78) Example 1 is an apparatus comprising: a photonics die; and a micro-lens array physically and optically coupled with a surface of the photonics die, the micro-lens array includes one or more lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple optical channels.

(79) Example 2 may include the apparatus of example 1, wherein the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array are in a line.

(80) Example 3 may include the apparatus of example 2, wherein the micro-lens array further includes a plurality of micro-lens arrays.

(81) Example 4 may include the apparatus of example 3, wherein the plurality of micro-lens arrays are in a line, and wherein the one or more lenses of each of the micro-lens arrays are in a line.

(82) Example 5 may include the apparatus of example 3, wherein the plurality of micro-lens arrays are parallel, and wherein the one or more lenses of each of the micro-lens arrays the form parallel lines.

(83) Example 6 may include the apparatus of example 1, wherein the surface of the photonics die is a top or a bottom surface of the photonics die.

(84) Example 7 may include the apparatus of example 1, further comprising one or more physical features on the photonics die to align the micro-lens array with the surface of the photonics die prior to physical and optical coupling of the micro-lens array to the surface of the photonics die.

(85) Example 8 may include the apparatus of example 7, wherein the surface of the photonics die includes one or more V-grooves to receive the one or more physical features on the photonics die.

(86) Example 9 may include the apparatus of example 8, wherein a first surface of the micro-lens array that includes multiple lenses is opposite a second surface of the micro-lens array; and further comprising one or more features of the second surface of the micro-lens array, wherein the one or more features of the second surface are to fit, respectively, into the one or more V-grooves of the surface of the photonics die.

(87) Example 10 may include the apparatus of example 1, wherein the micro-lens array is physically and optically coupled with the surface of the photonics die using an epoxy.

(88) Example 11 may include the apparatus of example 10, wherein the surface of the photonics die further includes an epoxy barrier to keep the epoxy used to physically couple the micro-lens array with the surface of the photonics die from entering a region on the surface of the photonics die.

(89) Example 12 may include the apparatus of example 11, wherein the region on the surface of the photonics die includes a bump region.

(90) Example 13 may include the apparatus of example 1, wherein the photonics die is a silicon photonics die.

(91) Example 14 may include the apparatus of example 1, wherein the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array are in a line.

(92) Example 15 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 1-14, further comprising one or more grating couplers embedded into the surface of the photonics die, each grating coupler positioned, respectively, proximate to each lens to facilitate the transmission or reception of light between each lens of the lens-array and the photonics die.

(93) Example 16 may be a method, comprising: identifying a photonics die; identifying a micro-lens array, the micro-lens array includes one or more lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple channels; and optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die.

(94) Example 17 may include the method of example 16, wherein optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die further includes applying an epoxy to optically and physically couple the micro-lens array to the surface of the photonics die.

(95) Example 18 may include the method of any one of examples 16-17, wherein optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die further includes aligning one or more physical features of the micro-lens array with one or more physical features of the surface of the photonics die.

(96) Example 19 is a package, comprising: a photonics device, comprising: a photonics die; and a micro-lens array physically and optically coupled with a surface of the photonics die, the micro-lens array includes one or more lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple channels; and a component of a photonics package physically coupled with the photonics device, the physical coupling providing a light path to optically couple with the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array.

(97) Example 20 may include the package of example 19, wherein the component is electrically coupled with the photonics device.

(98) Example 21 may include the package of example 19, wherein the photonics die is a silicon photonics die.

(99) Example 22 may include the package of example 19, wherein the component further includes an opening proximate to the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array, the opening to provide the light path.

(100) Example 23 may include the package of example 19, wherein the component includes one or more lenses that are proximate to and optically coupled with the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array.

(101) Example 24 may include the package of example 19, wherein the component of the photonics

package is a selected one of: a substrate, an integrated heat spreader (IHS), a system on chip (SOC), a CPU, a graphics processor unit (GPU), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or an accelerator.

(102) Example 25 may include the package of any one of examples 19-24, wherein the light path includes a reflector to change a direction of light traveling in the light path.

Claims

1. An apparatus comprising: a photonics die, the photonics die having a plurality of conductive bumps and a barrier on a surface, the barrier comprising an epoxy material; a micro-lens array physically and optically coupled with the surface of the photonics die, the micro-lens array comprising a plurality of lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple optical channels, wherein the barrier is between the plurality of conductive bumps and the micro-lens array; and a plurality of grating couplers embedded in the surface of the photonics die, each one of the plurality of lenses vertically overlapping with a corresponding one of the plurality of grating couplers to facilitate the transmission or reception of light between each one of the plurality of lenses of the micro-lens array and the photonics die, and each one of the plurality of lenses having a convex surface facing away from the corresponding one of the plurality of grating couplers.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the plurality of lenses of the micro-lens array are in a line.
3. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the micro-lens array further includes a plurality of micro-lens arrays.
4. The apparatus of claim 3, wherein the plurality of micro-lens arrays are in a line, and wherein the plurality of lenses of each of the micro-lens arrays are in a line.
5. The apparatus of claim 3, wherein the plurality of micro-lens arrays are parallel, and wherein the plurality of lenses of each of the micro-lens arrays the form parallel lines.
6. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the surface of the photonics die is a top or a bottom surface of the photonics die.
7. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising one or more physical features on the photonics die to align the micro-lens array with the surface of the photonics die prior to physical and optical coupling of the micro-lens array to the surface of the photonics die.
8. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the surface of the photonics die includes one or more V-grooves to receive the one or more physical features on the photonics die.
9. The apparatus of claim 8, wherein a first surface of the micro-lens array that includes multiple lenses is opposite a second surface of the micro-lens array; and further comprising one or more features of the second surface of the micro-lens array, wherein the one or more features of the second surface are to fit, respectively, into the one or more V-grooves of the surface of the photonics die.
10. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the micro-lens array is physically and optically coupled with the surface of the photonics die using an epoxy.
11. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the photonics die is a silicon photonics die.
12. A method, comprising: identifying a photonics die, the photonics die having a plurality of conductive bumps and a barrier on a surface, the barrier comprising an epoxy material; identifying a micro-lens array, the micro-lens array comprising a plurality of lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple channels; and optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die, wherein the barrier is between the plurality of conductive bumps and the micro-lens array, wherein a plurality of grating couplers is embedded in the surface of the photonics die, each one of the plurality of lenses vertically overlapping with a corresponding one of the plurality of grating couplers to facilitate the transmission or reception of light between each one of the plurality of lenses of the micro-lens array and the photonics die, and each one of the plurality of lenses having a convex surface facing away from the corresponding one of the plurality of

grating couplers.

13. The method of claim 12, wherein optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die further includes applying an epoxy to optically and physically couple the micro-lens array to the surface of the photonics die.

14. The method of claim 12, wherein optically and physically coupling the micro-lens array to a surface of the photonics die further includes aligning one or more physical features of the micro-lens array with one or more physical features of the surface of the photonics die.

15. A package, comprising: a photonics device, comprising: a photonics die, the photonics die having a plurality of conductive bumps and a barrier on a surface, the barrier comprising an epoxy material; a micro-lens array physically and optically coupled with the surface of the photonics die, the micro-lens array comprising a plurality of lenses to receive or to transmit light signals over multiple channels, wherein the barrier is between the plurality of conductive bumps and the micro-lens array; a plurality of grating couplers embedded in the surface of the photonics die, each one of the plurality of lenses vertically overlapping with a corresponding one of the plurality of grating couplers to facilitate the transmission or reception of light between each one of the plurality of lenses of the micro-lens array and the photonics die, and each one of the plurality of lenses having a convex surface facing away from the corresponding one of the plurality of grating couplers; and a component of a photonics package physically coupled with the photonics device, the physical coupling providing a light path to optically couple with the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array.

16. The package of claim 15, wherein the component is electrically coupled with the photonics device.

17. The package of claim 15, wherein the photonics die is a silicon photonics die.

18. The package of claim 15, wherein the component further includes an opening proximate to the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array, the opening to provide the light path.

19. The package of claim 15, wherein the component includes one or more lenses that are proximate to and optically coupled with the one or more lenses of the micro-lens array.

20. The package of claim 15, wherein the component of the photonics package is a selected one of: a substrate, an integrated heat spreader (IHS), a system on chip (SOC), a CPU, a graphics processor unit (GPU), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or an accelerator.

21. The package of claim 15, wherein the light path includes a reflector to change a direction of light traveling in the light path.
